

Chagai M. Weiss

CONTACT

INFORMATION

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APPOINTMENTS

The University of Toronto

Assistant Professor and Andrea & Charles Bronfman Chair in Israel Studies July 2025–

- Department of Political Science
- Anne Tanenbaum Centre for Jewish Studies

Stanford University

Affiliated Faculty, Politics and Social Change Lab 2025–

Koret Postdoctoral Fellow, Politics and Social Change Lab 2024–2025

Postdoctoral Fellow, Conflict and Polarization Initiative 2022–2024

Harvard University

Middle East Initiative Predoctoral Fellow, Harvard Kennedy School 2020–2022

EDUCATION

The University of Wisconsin–Madison

Ph.D., Political Science 2022

- **Dissertation:** Prejudice Reduction at Scale: How Institutional Inclusion Reduces Social Exclusion

★ *Best Dissertation in Comparative Politics Award*, UW–Madison (2022)

- **Fields:** Comparative Politics, International Relations, Political Methodology (*minor*)

M.A., Political Science 2018

The Hebrew University of Jerusalem

B.A., Political Science & Middle Eastern Studies 2016

- *cum laude*

BOOKS

2. **Weiss, Chagai M.** “Delivering Tolerance: How Unintended Institutional Inclusion Reduces Prejudice.” **Princeton University Press**, *Princeton Studies in Political Behavior* (2026).
1. Brutger, Ryan, Joshua D. Kertzer, Jonathan Renshon, and **Chagai M. Weiss**. “Abstraction in Experimental Design: Testing the Tradeoffs.” **Cambridge University Press**, *Elements in Experimental Political Science* (2022).

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

16. **Weiss, Chagai M.**, Donald Green, and Robb Willer. “Can Politicians Bridge Partisan Divides? Evidence from a Field Experiment with the U.S. National Governors Association.” Accepted for publication at *American Journal of Political Science*.
★ *Analyst Institute Expy Award for Bridging Research and Practice* (2025)
15. **Weiss, Chagai M.**, Alexandra Scacco, and Alexandra Siegel. “Outgroup Avoidance.” Forthcoming in *Journal of Politics*.
14. Bassan-Nygate, Lotem, Jonathan Renshon, Jessica Weeks, and **Chagai M. Weiss**. “The Generalizability of IR Experiments Beyond the U.S.” Forthcoming in *American Political Science Review*.

13. Jha, Saumitra, Moses Shayo, and **Chagai M. Weiss**. “Financial Market Participation Increases Generalized Trust, Particularly Among the Politically Polarized.” *Journal of Public Economics*, 242 (2025).
 - *Stanford GSB Working Paper No. 4083*
12. Kao, Kristen, Ellen Lust, Marwa Shalaby, and **Chagai M. Weiss**. “Group Gender Composition and Perceptions of Legitimacy.” *American Political Science Review*, 118(1) (2024).
11. **Weiss, Chagai M.**, Neal Tsur, Dan Miodownik, Yonatan Lupu, and Evgeny Finkel. “Atypical Violence and Conflict Dynamics: Evidence from Jerusalem.” *Political Science Research and Methods*, 12(2) (2024).
10. **Weiss, Chagai M.**, Eran Halperin, and Shira Ran. “Educating for Inclusion: Diversity Education Programs Can Reduce Prejudice Toward Outgroups in Israel.” *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 120(16) (2023).
 - ★ *APSA Experimental Research Section Best Paper Award* (2023)
9. **Weiss, Chagai M.**, Alexandra Siegel, and David Romney. “How Threats of Exclusion Mobilize Palestinian Political Participation.” *American Journal of Political Science*, 67(4) (2023).
8. Brutger, Ryan, Joshua D. Kertzer, Jonathan Renshon, Dustin Tingley, and **Chagai M. Weiss**. “Abstraction and Detail in Experimental Design.” *American Journal of Political Science*, 67(4) (2023).
7. Getmansky, Anna, and **Chagai M. Weiss**. “Wartime Military Service Can Affect Partisan Preferences.” *Comparative Political Studies*, 56(10) (2023).
6. Getmansky, Anna, and **Chagai M. Weiss**. “Interstate Conflict Can Reduce Support for Incumbents: Evidence from the Israeli Electorate and the Yom Kippur War.” *Journal of Conflict Resolution*, 67(2-3) (2023).
5. Peyton, Kyle, **Chagai M. Weiss**, and Paige Vaughn. “Beliefs About Minority Representation in Policing and Preferences for Increasing Officer Diversity.” *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 119(52) (2022).
 - ★ *MPSA Lucius Barker Award* (2023)
4. Bassan-Nygate, Lotem, and **Chagai M. Weiss**. “Party Competition and Cooperation Shape Affective Polarization: Evidence from Natural and Survey Experiments in Israel.” *Comparative Political Studies*, 55(2) (2022).
 - ★ *George and Sylvia Laikin Prize, UW–Madison* (2021)
 - ★ *Mildred Potter Hovland Journal Article Prize, UW–Madison* (2021)
3. **Weiss, Chagai M.**. “Diversity in Health Care Institutions Reduces Israeli Patients’ Prejudice Toward Arabs.” *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 118(14) (2021).
 - ★ *APSA Conflict Processes Best Paper Award* (2019)
 - ★ *Genevieve Gorst Herfurth Award, Honorable Mention, UW–Madison* (2021)
2. Gilad, Sharon, Saar Alon-Barkat, and **Chagai M. Weiss**. “Political and Bureaucratic Translation of Social Movement Demands: The Case of Israel’s 2011 Social Protest.” *Governance*, 32(2) (2019).
1. Rock, Jonathan, **Chagai M. Weiss**, and Dan Miodownik. “Geographies of Violence in Jerusalem: The Spatial Logic of Intergroup Conflict.” *Political Geography*, 66 (2018).

WORKING PAPERS

4. Siegel, Alexandra, and **Chagai M. Weiss**. “Polarizing Effects of Attacks on the Press: Evidence from Israel.” Invited to revise and resubmit at *American Political Science Review*.
3. **Weiss, Chagai M.**, Sascha Riaz, Julie Cachia, and Xuan Zhao. “Does Reducing Psychological Distress Increase Support for Liberal Democracy?” Invited to revise and resubmit as a registered report at *American Political Science Review*.
2. **Weiss, Chagai M.** “Prejudice: Causes, Effects, and Remedies.” In preparation for *Annual Review of Political Science*.
1. Hanlon, Michelle, Saumitra Jha, Namrata Kala, Nemit Shroff, and **Chagai M. Weiss**. “Seeing Green: The Effects of Financial Exposures on Support for Climate Action.”
 - *NBER Working Paper No. 34828*

IN PROGRESS

4. **Weiss, Chagai M.**, Zeynep Biyikli, Michael Baumer, Donald Green, James Slezak, and Robb Willer. “Persuasion at Scale: Evidence from Meta-Analyses of Proprietary Experiments and Addressable TV RCTs.”
3. Hilbig, Hanno, and **Chagai M. Weiss**. “Resisting Integration: How Religious Minorities React to Threats of Conscription.”
2. Riaz, Sascha, and **Chagai M. Weiss**. “The Political Salience of the Israeli–Palestinian Conflict: Evidence from 4.1 million parliamentary speeches around the world.”
1. Dinas, Elias, Vasiliki Fouka, and **Chagai M. Weiss**. “The Evolution of Minority Group Social Norms: Evidence from the Jewish Response.”

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

6. **Weiss, Chagai M.** “Group Identity, Ingroups, and Their Implications.” In *Handbook of Innovations in Political Psychology*, edited by Ethan C. Busby, Christopher F. Karpowicz, and Cara J. Wong. Edward Elgar Publishing, 2024.
5. Littman, Rebecca, Alexandra Scacco, and **Chagai M. Weiss**. “Reducing Prejudice through Intergroup Contact Interventions.” In *Psychological Intergroup Interventions*. Routledge, 2024.
4. Shalaby, Marwa, **Chagai M. Weiss**, Ellen Lust, Kristen Kao, and coauthors. “The Dynamics of Decentralization in the MENA: Processes, Outcomes, and Obstacles.” *Program on Governance and Local Development Working Paper No. 31*.
3. **Weiss, Chagai M.** “Sharing Spaces: Segregation, Integration, and Intergroup Relations.” *APSA Comparative Politics Newsletter*, Spring 2020.
2. Bassan-Nygate, Lotem, and **Chagai M. Weiss**. “It’s Us or Them: Partisan Polarization in Israel and Beyond.” *APSA MENA Newsletter*, Spring 2020.
1. **Weiss, Chagai M.** “Segregation, Integration, and Intergroup Relations in Israel.” *POMEPS Working Paper*, Fall 2020.

SELECTED OUTREACH

- “Another payoff from trading stocks: Reducing political polarization.” *Stanford Graduate School of Business Insights*, August 2023.
- “The Experiment that Revealed: Watching this Show Reduces Prejudice.” *KAN News (Israel)*, 2023.

- “Israel is voting—for the third time in a year. That’s polarizing voters even more.” *The Monkey Cage*, February 2020. (With Lotem Bassan-Nygate).
- “An HBO series looks at political violence in Jerusalem. Here’s the reality behind the drama.” *The Monkey Cage*, September 2019.
- “How might recent confrontations with Hamas influence Israeli elections?” *The Monkey Cage*, December 2018.

INVITED TALKS

- 2027:** OSU, *Identity and Politics Speaker Series*, **Harvard**, *WoGPop*.
- 2026:** **Columbia**, *Media Effects Empirical Workshop*, **McGill University**, *Center for the Study of Democratic Citizenship*, **Georgetown**, *Mortara Research Seminar*.
- 2025:** **UC Berkeley**, *Citrin Center for Public Opinion Research*, **UCLA**, *Department of Political Science*, **BYU**, *Initiative for Peacemaking*, **UCLA**, *Nazarian Center for Israel Studies*.
- 2024:** **Princeton**, *Center for the Study of Democratic Politics*, **Meta**, *Computational Social Science Seminar*, **Princeton**, *Program on Race, Ethnicity, and Identity in Politics*, **CEGA**, **ESOC**, and **U.N. Behavioral Insights**, *Roundtable on Engineering Peace*, **National Institute for Civil Discourse**, *Community Briefing on Effective Depolarization Interventions*.
- 2023:** **Stanford**, *Identity Politics Seminar*, **UC Berkeley**, *IR Speaker Series*, **Stanford**, *Polarization and Social Change Lab*, **WashU**, *10th Comparative Politics Annual Conference*, **Stanford**, *CDDRL Speaker Series*, **Harvard**, *Weatherhead Research Cluster on Identity Politics*, **UPenn**, *Comparative Politics Workshop*.
- 2022:** **UC Irvine**, *Department of Political Science*, *Survey Methodology Seminar*, **Harvard**, *Department of Psychology*.
- 2021:** **Hebrew University** (Israel), *PCIR Lab*, **Harvard**, *Cushman-Greene Lab*.
- 2020:** **Ben-Gurion University** (Israel), *Department of Economics*, **WZB Berlin** (Germany), *Institutions and Political Inequality Speakers Series*.
- 2019:** **George Washington University**, *Workshop on Israeli politics*.

CONFERENCES

- 2026:** Bocconi-Columbia Conference on Democratic Resilience (Columbia).
- 2025:** New Research on Inclusive Nationalism (Yale), Polarization Research Lab Annual Conference (Salt Lake City), MOPED (WZB Berlin), EPSA (Madrid), APSA (Vancouver), The Future of Democracy? (WZB Berlin).
- 2023:** MPSA (Chicago), PolMeth (Stanford), APSA (Los Angeles).
- 2022:** Overcoming Prejudice Conference (University of Pennsylvania), MPSA (Chicago), Berlin Meeting on the Political Economy of Development (WZB Berlin), PolMeth (St. Louis), APSA (Montreal), Toronto Political Behavior Workshop (Toronto).
- 2021:** APSA (Seattle), PolMeth Europe (Virtual Poster), MPSA (Virtual), Harvard Experimental Political Science Conference (Virtual), Chicago Area Political and Social Behavior CAB Workshop (Virtual Poster, hosted at Northwestern University).
- 2020:** The Dynamics of Decentralization in MENA (The University of Gothenburg), CSES Conference on Experimental Political Science (NYU), POMEPS Working Group (Virtual), APSA (Virtual).
- 2019:** Eurasian Peace Science (Jerusalem), Winter Experimental Social Science Institute (WESSI, NYU Abu-Dhabi), Economic Science Association (ESA, NYU Abu-Dhabi), ISA (Toronto), MPSA (Chicago), Political Psychology APSA Pre-Conference (Washington D.C.), APSA (Washington D.C.), Peace Science (Manhattan, Kansas).
- 2018:** ISA (San Francisco).

AWARDS & GRANTS

Dean's Excellence Award , University of Toronto	2025–2026
SSHRC Insight Development Grant	2026–2028
Andrew Carnegie Fellowship	2026–2028
Public Agenda Research Fund Award	Spring 2024
Democracy Communications Fund Research Award	Spring 2024
Center for Jewish Studies Travel Grant , UW–Madison	Summer 2022
National Science Foundation PolMeth Conference Travel Grant	Summer 2022
Charles and Gayle Mazursky Student Support Fund , UW–Madison	Spring 2021
Political Science Summer Writing Grant , UW–Madison	2021
Political Science Summer Initiative Grant , UW–Madison	2021
Horowitz Foundation for Social Policy Research Grant , National Competition	2020
Graduate Student Travel/Research Grant Competition , UW–Madison	2020
Political Science Summer Initiative Grant , UW–Madison	2020
POMEPS Travel Grant	2020
IRIS Graduate Student Summer Fieldwork Award , UW–Madison	2019
The Morris Abrams Award in International Relations , National Competition	2019
Political Science Summer Initiative Grant , UW–Madison	2019
IR Graduate Student Travel/Research Grant Competition , UW–Madison	2019
Graduate Student Travel Award , Elections Research Center, UW–Madison	2019
Best Graduate Paper in the 8th Eurasian Peace Science Conference	2019
Charles and Gayle Mazursky Student Support Fund , UW–Madison	Fall 2018
Student Research Travel Grant , UW–Madison	2018
Foreign Language and Area Studies (FLAS) Yearly Fellowship (<i>Declined</i>)	2018
The Maurice Falk Institute for Economic Research in Israel , Hebrew University	2018
The Harry S. Truman Institute Research Grant , Hebrew University	2018
Israel Institute Research Grant	2018
Charles and Gayle Mazursky Student Support Fund , UW–Madison	Spring 2018
Foreign Language and Area Studies (FLAS) Summer Fellowship	2018
IR Graduate Student Travel/Research Grant Competition , UW–Madison	2018
Minerva Center for Human Rights Research Grant , Hebrew University	2017
Isaac and Ida Lipton Study Abroad Fellowship , UW–Madison	2017
Charles and Gayle Mazursky Student Support Fund , UW–Madison	Fall 2017

TEACHING

Primary Instructor:

The Politics of Identity and Intergroup Relations in Israel	Fall 2026
Advanced Undergraduate Course, The University of Toronto.	
Causal Inference	Fall 2025
Graduate Course, The University of Toronto.	

Teaching Assistant:

Research Methods in Political Science	Fall 2018
Professor Jessica Weeks, University of Wisconsin–Madison	

SERVICE

Journal Referee: *American Journal of Political Science*, *American Political Science Review*, *Comparative Political Studies*, *Conflict Management and Peace Science*, *Conflict Resolution Quarterly*, *Economic Journal*, *Electoral Studies*, *Ethnopolitics*, *Frontiers in Psychology*, *Human Rights Review*, *International Organization*, *International Studies Quarterly*, *Journal of Accounting and Economics*, *Journal of Conflict Resolution*, *Journal of*

Elections, Public Opinion and Parties, Journal of Experimental Political Science, Journal of Hospital Management and Health Policy, Journal of Peace Research, Journal of Politics, Local Government Studies, Nature Human Behaviour, Organizational Behavior and Human Decision Processes, Party Politics, PNAS, PNAS Nexus, Political Behavior, Political Geography, Political Psychology, Political Research Quarterly, Political Science Research and Methods, Political Studies, Psychological Science, Public Administration, Public Opinion Quarterly, Quarterly Journal of Economics, Science Advances, Social Psychological and Personality Science, World Politics.

Press Referee: *Cambridge University Press (Elements in Experimental Political Science), Oxford University Press, Princeton University Press.*

Funding Referee: *The German Israeli Foundation For Scientific Research & Development, National Science Foundation, Strengthening Democracy Field Test Grants, TESS, U.S.-Israel Binational Science Foundation.*

Award Committees: *APSA best paper award in experimental political science (2023), MPSA best paper award in political behavior (2025), APSA best paper award in experimental political science (2025).*

OTHER PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Strategies for Civic Inclusion Network Team Member	2025–
Polarization Research Lab Global Advisor	2023–
aChord – Social Psychology for Social Change Research Consultant, Israel	2020
Zulat – Equality and Human Rights Research Consultant, Israel	2020

LANGUAGES

Hebrew (Native), **Modern Standard Arabic** (Advanced), **Levantine Arabic** (Intermediate)

LAST UPDATED:

August 27, 2026